containment measures at local levels. The prime minister was also briefed on the progress of vaccine development where production capacities of SII and Bharat Biotech were discussed along with efforts to ramp up production. He was also informed about the conversations of NEGVAC with foreign vaccine manufacturers and the outcome of those conversations. He grew concerned and informed his team that COVID-19 should be fought in a mission-mode approach in states and districts which were reporting high caseloads so that the efforts that we had made so far over the past 15 months wouldn't be squandered. Recognizing the need for transparency in the vaccination drive, he asserted that states and UTs must be informed of daily performance and their feedback should be taken from time to time so that appropriate timely changes could be made.[11]

Four days later, in a video conference with all the chief ministers, he reiterated the worrisome situation the country was heading in as it crossed the peak number of cases seen during the first wave. He directed the chief ministers to mindfully impose local curbs while initiating aggressive awareness campaigns to urge people to follow COVID-19-appropriate behaviour. He particularly stressed on the importance of micro-containment strategies instead of broadband lockdowns. He gave an example of night curfews in particular as an effective strategy around the world,

> Today, when India has developed all the resources required towards the COVID fight, it is now time to go through the test of our governance. Our emphasis should be on micro containment zones. Wherever night curfew is in place, the phrase 'corona curfew' should be used there so that awareness regarding coronavirus is maintained. Some people have this intellectual debate whether corona strikes at night. (It does not.) However, the imposition of night curfew has been an accepted experiment globally because it serves as a reminder to people that they're living in the Corona-era (to make them aware to keep following COVID protocol) while their daily activities are not affected to a large extent. It is best if 'corona curfew' starts at 9 PM or 10 PM in the night and goes on till 5 AM or 6 AM in the morning, so that other activities are not affected.[12]

Shekhar Gupta, editor of *ThePrint* and a long-time media personality, had tweeted, 'There's a new addition to the list of The Great Indian Absurdities.